ON THE ISLANDS, RELIEF AND A CALCULATION

The Coastal Ledger

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FENWICK ISLE — The bill that passed this week will, if signed, add one per cent to the price of every qualifying house sold on this island and two per cent to the cost of substantial renovation.

Islanders we spoke to were divided, and the division did not run the way the sponsors expected. Owners who had rebuilt after the 2021 storm were largely in favour. Those trying to sell were not.

“I have had the house on the market since spring,” said one owner in the village. “Whoever buys it now pays the State for the privilege of taking on my flood risk.”

The Coastal Alliance, which represents owners in the designated zones, supports the bill but only as a package. “If they strike the producer charges and keep ours, we will have paid for someone else’s damage,” its president said. She said the Alliance had asked the Revenue Department and the Fiscal Office to put the two annual figures side by side and that neither had done so.

The whole of this island is inside the designation, whatever its distance from the water. 2,247 parcels are affected, of which the assessor’s office says roughly 93.5 per cent are valued above the threshold in the bill.

The Coastal Ledger serves the offshore communities.